



WHAT Reliance gets for \$1.2 billion

- A joint venture with DreamWorks and access to Spielberg, the world's top most director, with a total box-office gross of \$4 bn.
- All India theatrical and home video rights to films being made under the new banner with Stacy Snider as CEO.
- Foothold in Hollywood global business. A possible investment in MGM will make it a bigger international media player.

WHAT Reliance does not get

- Access to DreamWorks library, which has hugely successful movies such as *Gladiator* and *Transformers*.
- Access to DreamWorks Animation, which has produced money-spinners such as the *Shrek* franchise.
- Movies under production with earlier partner Paramount Pictures, including the *Transformers* sequel.

WHAT is yet to be decided

- Who gets Spielberg's *Lincoln* and Peter Jackson's *Tintin*, under development with DreamWorks and Paramount?
- Who will distribute films from the new 50:50 DreamWorks-Reliance company? Will it be Universal Studios?
- How many movies will Spielberg direct for the new company as he has always worked for outside studios as well?

Yet by all accounts, it is an audacious move on the part of the Reliance-ADAG group. At a time when Bollywood studios were over the moon with their foot-in-the-door deals in Hollywood, Reliance has bought the entire door, with bells and whistles on it. DreamWorks, never a full-fledged studio despite the best intentions of its founders Spielberg, Katzenberg and music mogul Geffen, is way more valuable than UTV's one-movie deal with Manoj Night Shyamalan, its three-film deal with Will Smith-James Lassiter's Overbrook Productions, and even Reliance's own deal, inherited from its days as a 51 per cent partner in Adlabs, of three movies with Ashok Amritraj's Hyde Park Entertainment.

It's taken Team Reliance almost two years to pull off this deal. Reliance Big Entertainment Chairman Amit Khanna, one of the most ubiquitous members of the Mumbai film industry, and president Rajesh Sawhney, who was headhunted from the Times Group, clocked up 20 trips since

MEN WHO MATTER: Steven Spielberg (left) and Anil Ambani

\$130-million adaptation of *Tintin*, again with Jackson. If, however, Paramount moves forward with any films that Spielberg is attached to direct or produce, it will have to pay DreamWorks 7.5 per cent of the gross and 50 per cent of the profits to cash break, a costly proposition for the com-

pany. In fact, it's not even DreamWorks SKG, with the K, as in Katzenberg busy running DreamWorks Animation, and the G, David Geffen, not being part of the new venture and choosing to, at least for now, literally sail into the sunset with buddy Larry Ellison, aboard their 453-ft yacht *Rising Sun*.